



Pablo Picasso, Motherhood (1901)

PSYCHOSOCIAL RESEARCH ROUNDS

Social media use and perinatal mental health: A scoping review

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Session chaired by Vincent Paquin, MD

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1:30 PM – 2:00 PM (ET)

ICFP Amphitheatre, 4333 Côte-St-Catherine Rd., Montreal QC H3T 1E4

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Learning objectives

- Describe the current evidence on the relationship between social media use and parental mental health during the perinatal period, including both positive and negative effects.
- Identify how characteristics of social media use (e.g., platform, frequency, type of engagement, and purpose of use) are associated with mental health outcomes such as depression, anxiety, and psychological distress in perinatal populations.
- Recognize gaps in the existing literature regarding social media use and perinatal mental health to inform future research and clinical practice.

Abstract

Background/Objective: The perinatal period is a time of increased vulnerability for mental health challenges, including depression, anxiety, and psychological distress among both birthing and non-birthing parents. Social media has become an important source of support, information, and community during pregnancy and postpartum, but it may also contribute to negative mental health outcomes. This scoping review aims to examine the relationship between social media use and mental health during the perinatal period across parental roles.

Methods: A comprehensive search was conducted in MEDLINE, PsycINFO, CINAHL, and Embase for peer-reviewed studies published from 2015 onward. Eligible studies included pregnant individuals, postpartum individuals up to one year after delivery, and non-birthing expecting parents. Two independent reviewers are screening studies and extracting data on study characteristics, participant demographics, measures of social media use, and mental health outcomes.

Results: The extracted literature is being synthesized to characterize current evidence on how social media use relates to perinatal mental health.

Conclusion: This scoping review will provide a comprehensive overview of the current evidence regarding social media and perinatal mental health, highlighting knowledge gaps, and informing future research, clinical practice, and interventions.

About

My name is Lucia Shi, and I am a second-year medical student at McGill University. I am interested in mental health research and improving patient care through evidence-based approaches. I am currently working on scoping reviews in Dr. Paquin's Digital Culture and Mental Health Lab. Outside of academics, I enjoy acrylic painting, crocheting and hiking.

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